

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

iSpeak

The world's been in love with Apple's products since the launch of the first iMac, and after the iPod, Apple's iCult has expanded manifold—fans are falling over themselves claiming they know what the next iProduct is going to be. Here, we present a quick guide to iProducts that exist, don't exist, and aren't even Apple. Of course, you'll need to figure out which ones are which first—we sure aren't going to tell you! Like they say, the best way to learn bluffing is to be on the receiving end once in a while.

iHome: Apple's answer to the Windows Media Center PCs, this gorgeous iMac-based media centre came on to the scene around MacWorld 2005.

iTV: This is supposedly just a code-name for the video-streaming device. The set top box will let you watch high-definition video on your television, and is about the size of a Mac Mini.

iWalk: Really now, the Newton debacle had to be avenged eventually, didn't it? The iWalk PDA will even run Palm applications thanks to the emulation layer on its *nix-based OS.

iDog: This Aibo-esque pet will dance to your music at your slightest whim—and if that music comes from your iPod, even better!

iTablet: Using Apple's patented multi-touchscreen, you can now use all your fingers to "crush" a big window, a la *Minority Report*!

iPhone: Is it fake? Is it real? Rumours of Apple's "inevitable" music phone have been entertaining us for ages. We predict three new rumours between our writing this and your reading it.

Now go online and find out—iReal or iFake?

Wild Wild Web

Four, Oh Four!

It's almost too often that you receive forwards with variations on a theme, but here's a page we really feel like mentioning. The theme is this: "Is there an art of 404 pages?" And the variations are many and funny.

Consider, for example, the "Philosophical" one:

"The Web page you seek Cannot be located but Endless others exist."

That one's almost a koan.

(If you don't know what a koan is, you should be ashamed of being Asian, you klutz! (Heh! Just kidding! Google it!))

There are many at www.365questions.org/2006/10/15/is-there-an-art-of-404-pages, but here's our pick - "For psychos":

Server Error-404

Psychiatric Support Page
Your file cannot be found!
...Please try the following:

1. If you are *obsessive-compulsive*, please check the URL repeatedly. ...
3. If you are *paranoid-delusional*, we know who you are and what you want. Just stay online until we can

trace your computer.

4. If you are *schizophrenic*, listen carefully and a little voice will tell you the correct URL.

Be sure to check out the "Rude" one! *Warning: Explicit Content*

The Google Graveyard

Head to www.seopedia.org/seo-news/google/goggles-56-forgotten-secret-pages-part-two. This is the second instalment of



forgotten and unused Google pages which you probably never knew existed! Here's a sampling of weird stuff you can actually find at Google.com.

1. www.google.com/explanation.html: Google's explanation of their disturbing results when searching for "Jew".

2. www.google-store.com:

The Google Store—a very colourful page where you can buy stuff branded with Google, like a Google beach towel or a White Google Polo Shirt. Like anyone needs to promote Google!

3. www.google.com/Easter/feature_easter.html:

The 2000 Google Easter Animation, where you catch the eggs in order to spell "Google". If you complete the game twice, there's a surprise, according to seopedia.com! Try it and tell us—it's a bloody silly game, so we didn't try it—but we'd like to know what the surprise is!

4. www.google.com/jobs/reasons.html: Top ten reasons to work at Google. Here's a sample: "Good company everywhere you look. Googlers range from former neurosurgeons, CEOs, and US puzzle champions to alligator wrestlers and former-Marines. No matter what their backgrounds Googlers make for interesting cube mates."

There are 56 pages listed on the site, and you should definitely give it a look!

entity that you really only see in a movie, but in many parts of the world people are killed or maimed by mines on a daily basis. Over the years, these users have repeatedly asked us to either remove minesweeper or change the concept from landmines to something a little less obnoxious."

Now what we're wondering is, they actually play Minesweeper in areas where they're getting killed "on a daily basis"? Is the game that great?

So anyway, the alternative Microsoft came up with for the interface is Flower Garden, where, ostensibly, you don't pluck a flower by mistake or something. But that's not all: they want to keep it Minesweeper in places where it isn't considered "obnoxious," and change it

to F.G. in places where it is. And this adds new twists to the tale. Vista lacks an easy way to change the name and icon for localisation; changing the name of the game could confuse people looking for Minesweeper, which would generate more support calls, and so forth. Actually, some people were even demanding that Minesweeper not be included with Vista at all.

What can we say? We looked up a popular discussion forum, and here are some of the comments:

1. *Why is it offending? You are looking for mines, not planting them.* Good point.
2. *What, some races can't handle bombs? Microsoft = racists.* Actually, it's not about race.
3. *Make it not selected by default, tell people who don't*

want it not to install it. The ideal solution, we think.

Wait a minute: why are we getting into all this?

FOR THE FUDDY-DUDDIES

Teens Say No To E-Mail

E-mail is, like, so yesterday. That's the sentiment amongst teens of today—at those of the American variety—according a new survey by a company with a very official-sounding name.

Teen e-mail use is dropping in favour of—you guessed it—more "instant" alternatives such as IM and MySpace. In fact, even IM use is dropping, and they're soon going to say IM is, like, you know, so yesterday.